



CODE APPEX

HACK THE UPSIDE DOWN

PARTICIPANTS HANDBOOK

DECRYPT. DESIGN. DEPLOY

OVERVIEW

VIT CODE APEX is a national-level flagship hackathon organized by AISF VIT Pune to bring together students interested in coding, problem-solving, and innovation. The hackathon offers a platform for exploring innovative ideas towards real-world problems using programming, development, and frontier technologies, connecting with different companies, and internship opportunities.

VIT CODE APEX 2.0 is the 2nd edition of Code Verse, which will be a grand flagship hackathon taking place on March 27 and 28.

HACKATHON STRUCTURE

ROUND 1: PPT SUBMISSION (ONLINE)

- Date: 16th – 18th March
 - The Online PPT Submission Round serves as the preliminary screening stage of the hackathon.
 - All registered teams are required to submit a presentation outlining their proposed approach, technical understanding, and problem-solving capability.
 - This round is designed to evaluate teams based on conceptual clarity, innovation potential, structured thinking, and technical feasibility.
 - Teams must clearly present: Understanding of the given theme, proposed solution framework, Technical approach and architecture Technology stack, implementation roadmap Expected impact and scalability

ROUND 2: PPT EVALUATION (ONLINE)

Date: 20th – 23rd March

- The PPT Evaluation Round serves as the second-stage screening of the hackathon.
- Shortlisted teams from Round 1 are required to present and pitch their solution to the panel of judges.
- Maximum 10 minutes to present.
- This round is designed to evaluate teams based on depth of understanding, clarity of explanation, innovation strength, technical feasibility, and presentation skills.
- Teams must clearly present:
 - o Understanding of the given theme
 - o Proposed solution framework
 - o Technical approach and architecture
 - o Technology stack
 - o Implementation roadmap
 - o Expected impact and scalability
- Teams should be prepared to answer questions and justify their design decisions during the live evaluation.

ROUND 3: HACKATHON (ON CAMPUS)

Date: 27th – 28th March

- Shortlisted teams from round 2 will be invited for 24-hour hackathon at campus (VIT Pune).
- A 24-hour hackathon where shortlisted teams will develop a working prototype.
- Mentors will be available throughout the development process for guidance.
- Teams will deliver final presentations and live demonstrations before the jury.
- Winners will be announced after evaluation based on innovation, execution, functionality, and real-world impact.

TEAM FORMATION & REGISTRATION

Team Size: 1-4 members

Eligibility: Open to all Students

Cross-institutional team formation allowed

Entry Fee:

250/- For VIT College Students

295/- Including GST for Non-VIT Students

*(295/- for all cross-institutional teams)

ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA

Engineering students (B.Tech/B.E.)

All branches allowed

All academic years (1st-4th)

Diploma students / All technical courses

JUDGING CRITERIA

Projects will be evaluated on the following parameters:

- Innovation and Creativity
- Technical Feasibility
- UI/UX and Functionality
- Presentation and Communication
- Real-World Impact

PRIZES & PERKS

- Cash Prizes for Winning Teams
- Goodies & Certificates for All Participants
- Networking & Mentorship Opportunities
- Internship opportunities

* (Internship opportunities depends upon the companies giving problem statement.)

PARTICIPANT GUIDELINES

- Before the Hackathon, ensure your team is registered before the deadline.
- Carry essentials: laptop, charger, extension board, valid college ID card, and any additional resources you may need.
- Plan for overnight coding accordingly. (carry required essentials.)

HOSPITALITY & PERKS

Dinner Provided: All participants will receive a complimentary breakfast, dinner, and tea.

HACKATHON RULES

- No multiple registrations or team switching allowed.
- Professional conduct is expected at all times.
- Project Rules All coding & development must be done during the hackathon.
- Open-source tools/libraries may be used (credit must be given, e.g., ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot) for assistance, **not** for complete project generation.

DISQUALIFICATION PARAMETERS

- Plagiarism or previously built projects.
- Offensive/disrespectful behavior.
- Absence during final presentations.
- Development outside permitted hours.

PARTICIPATION AGREEMENT

- By registering, you agree to:
- Uphold academic and professional integrity.
- Respect mentors, volunteers, and fellow participants.
- Complete all development during official hackathon hours.
- Present a functional prototype aligned with your submitted idea.

INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY & OWNERSHIP

- Participants retain full ownership of their original work.
- Organizers may use project details for promotional or academic purposes, with due credit given to the respective teams.
- Teams must ensure that their work does not violate any copyright laws or infringe upon third-party intellectual property rights.

GENERAL RULES

- The organizers reserve the right to modify the rules if required.
- Participants are responsible for their personal belongings.
- The organizing committee will not be held liable for any loss or damage.
- Participation implies acceptance of all rules and regulations stated herein.

PARTICIPATION AGREEMENT

- The management and conduct of the hackathon are solely the responsibility of the organizers, i.e., AISF.
- The organizers reserve the right to alter rules, schedules, or the event format if deemed necessary.
- The organizers/jury hold the right to disqualify a team in cases such as violation of rules or engagement in unlawful activities.
- Plagiarism, use of fabricated data, or presenting others' work as original.
- Misuse of AI tools or any form of unfair practice.
- Defensive, disrespectful, or disruptive behavior.
- The jury's decision will be final and binding; no appeals will be entertained.
- Participants are fully responsible for their personal belongings, equipment, and safety during the hackathon.
- The organizers will not be liable for any loss, damage, or technical failure.
- Teams must strictly adhere to all deadlines, submission guidelines, and time limits communicated during the event.
- The organizers retain the right to use photographs, videos, and project details for promotional purposes.
- Participants must ensure original content; use of copyrighted material without credit is strictly prohibited.

By registering, all participants agree to comply with these terms and any updates announced during the hackathon.